Medical Equipment

Category: **Medical, Healthcare & First Aid** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Medical Equipment

What it is used for

To inspect, prepare, and operate medical equipment according to its intended use and the manufacturer's instructions. To support safe patient care by verifying equipment condition, cleanliness, function, and required checks before use.

Main parts

- Main equipment unit and housing
- Power supply, battery, or charging system
- Controls, display, and indicators
- Sensors, probes, cables, or accessories as applicable
- Alarms and safety features, if fitted
- Cleaning, storage, and maintenance accessories

Before you start

1. Identify the exact device, intended use, and authorized operator requirements.
2. Read the manufacturer's instructions and the facility's relevant clinical procedure.
3. Inspect the casing, power cord, battery, cables, connectors, and accessories for damage.
4. Confirm that the equipment has the required inspection, maintenance, and calibration status where applicable.
5. Clean and disinfect the device and reusable accessories using the approved procedure for that device.
6. Check that the device is configured for the intended patient or task and that necessary supplies are available.
7. Verify alarm settings, self-test results, and functional checks where the manufacturer requires them.

How to use

1. Place the equipment on a stable surface or secure it to its approved mounting system.
2. Connect the approved power supply or confirm sufficient battery charge.
3. Switch on the device and allow its self-test or initialization sequence to finish.
4. Review any displayed errors, alerts, calibration prompts, or maintenance warnings.
5. Connect only compatible accessories and verify that they are fitted correctly.
6. Perform the required functional check using the manufacturer's approved method before patient use.
7. Set operating parameters only within the authorized clinical procedure and operator's training.

8. Explain the procedure to the patient when appropriate and confirm identity according to facility policy.
9. Use the equipment while observing the patient and monitoring relevant indicators or alarms.
10. Stop use and seek clinical or technical assistance if readings are implausible, alarms persist, or the device malfunctions.
11. After use, switch off the equipment and disconnect accessories according to the instructions.
12. Clean, disinfect, and store the device as required, and document faults or maintenance needs.

⚠ Safety

- Only trained and authorized personnel should operate medical equipment or use it for patient care.
- Never use equipment with damaged cables, cracked housing, failed safety checks, or unresolved alarms.
- Follow infection-prevention procedures and the manufacturer's approved cleaning and disinfection instructions.
- Do not change clinical settings or treatment parameters beyond the operator's authorization.
- Use only compatible accessories and approved power supplies.
- Keep liquids away from electrical connections unless the device is specifically designed for that exposure.
- Remove faulty equipment from service, label it clearly, and report it through the facility's maintenance process.

Care & storage

- Clean and disinfect the device and reusable accessories after use according to policy.
- Inspect cables, sensors, probes, connectors, and housing regularly.
- Charge and store batteries according to the manufacturer's instructions.
- Maintain calibration, electrical safety testing, and preventive maintenance records where applicable.
- Store equipment in a clean, dry, secure location and report damage promptly.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using a device without checking its identity, condition, or intended purpose.
- Ignoring failed self-tests, alarms, or overdue maintenance.
- Using incompatible or unclean accessories.
- Changing clinical parameters without authorization or adequate training.
- Returning faulty equipment to service without inspection and clearance.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.